

Altar Of Incense

This document describes the **Altar of Incense**, including its dimensions, construction, placement, function, and significance.

- **Construction and Design:** The Altar of Incense was made of shittim wood, overlaid with pure gold, and had a crown of gold around it. It had four rings of gold for staves, which were also made of shittim wood and overlaid with gold.
- **Placement:** It was placed before the Vail in the outer sanctuary of the Tabernacle, before the Ark of the Testimony and the Mercy Seat.
- **Function and Rituals:** The altar was used to burn incense every morning and evening. Only specific incense was allowed, and no other sacrifices were to be offered on it. The High Priest made atonement for the altar once a year with the blood of the Sin Offering. The blood of all sin offerings was also put on the horns of the altar.
- **Punishment:** There were severe consequences for offering strange fire or unauthorized offerings on the altar. Nadab and Abihu were consumed by fire for offering strange fire, and King Uzziah was struck with leprosy for burning incense on the altar.
- **Symbolism:** The Altar of Incense was covered by the priest before removal from the sanctuary and is seen as a type of Christ in the New Testament.
- **Overall Significance:** The altar was considered most holy and represented a place of communion with God and atonement for sins.

Dimensions.

Exodus 30:1. And thou shalt make an altar to burn incense upon: of shittim wood shalt thou make it.

Exodus 37:25. And he made the incense altar of shittim wood: the length of it was a cubit, and the breadth of it a cubit; it was foursquare; and two cubits was the height of it; the horns thereof were of the same.

Covered with gold.

Exodus 30:3. And thou shalt overlay it with pure gold, the top thereof, and the sides thereof round about, and the horns thereof; and thou shalt make unto it a crown of gold round about.

Exodus 37:26. And he overlaid it with pure gold, both the top of it, and the sides thereof round about, and the horns of it: also he made unto it a crown of gold round about.

Top of, surrounded with a crown of gold.

Exodus 30:3. And thou shalt overlay it with pure gold, the top thereof, and the sides thereof round about, and the horns thereof; and thou shalt make unto it a crown of gold round about.

Exodus 37:26. And he overlaid it with pure gold, both the top of it, and the sides thereof round about, and the horns of it: also he made unto it a crown of gold round about.

Had four rings of gold under the crown for the staves.

Exodus 30:4. And two golden rings shalt thou make to it under the crown of it, by the two corners thereof, upon the two sides of it shalt thou make it; and they shall be for places for the staves to bear it withal.

Exodus 37:27. And he made two rings of gold for it under the crown thereof, by the two corners of it, upon the two sides thereof, to be places for the staves to bear it withal.

Staves of, covered with gold.

Exodus 30:5. And thou shalt make the staves of shittim wood, and overlay them with gold.

Called the golden altar.

Exodus 39:38. And the golden altar, and the Anointing oil, and the sweet incense, and the hanging for The Tabernacle door,

Placed before The Vail in the outer sanctuary.

Exodus 30:6. And thou shalt put it before The Vail that is by the ark of the testimony, before the Mercy Seat that is over the testimony, where I will meet with thee.

Exodus 40:5. And thou shalt set the altar of gold for the incense before the ark of the testimony, and put the hanging of the door to The Tabernacle.

Exodus 40:26. And he put the golden altar in the tent of the Congregation before The Vail:

Said to be before the Lord.

Leviticus 4:7. And the priest shall put some of the blood upon the horns of the altar of sweet incense before the LORD, which is in The Tabernacle of the Congregation; and shall pour all the blood of the bullock at the bottom of the altar of the Burnt Offering, which is at the door of The Tabernacle of the Congregation.

1 Kings 9:25. And three times in a year did Solomon offer Burnt Offerings and Peace Offerings upon the altar which he built unto the LORD, and he burnt incense upon the altar that was before the LORD. So he finished the house.

Anointed with holy oil.

Exodus 30:26-27. And thou shalt anoint The Tabernacle of the Congregation therewith, and the ark of the testimony, And the table and all his vessels, and the candlestick and his vessels, and the Altar of Incense,

The priest burned incense on, every morning and evening.

Exodus 30:7-8. And Aaron shall burn thereon sweet incense every morning: when he dresseth the lamps, he shall burn incense upon it. And when Aaron lighteth the lamps at even, he shall burn incense upon it, a perpetual incense before the LORD throughout your

generations.

No strange incense nor any sacrifice to be offered on.

Exodus 30:9. Ye shall offer no strange incense thereon, nor burnt sacrifice, nor meat offering; neither shall ye pour drink offering thereon.

Atonement made for, by the High Priest once every year.

Exodus 30:10. And Aaron shall make an Atonement upon the horns of it once in a year with the blood of the Sin Offering of Atonements: once in the year shall he make Atonement upon it throughout your generations: it is most holy unto the LORD.

Leviticus 16:18-19. And he shall go out unto the altar that is before the LORD, and make an Atonement for it; and shall take of the blood of the bullock, and of the blood of the goat, and put it upon the horns of the altar round about. And he shall sprinkle of the blood upon it with his finger seven times, and cleanse it, and hallow it from the uncleanness of the children of Israel.

The blood of all sin offerings put on the horns of.

Leviticus 4:7. And the priest shall put some of the blood upon the horns of the altar of sweet incense before the LORD, which is in The Tabernacle of the Congregation; and shall pour all the blood of the bullock at the bottom of the altar of the Burnt Offering, which is at the door of The Tabernacle of the Congregation.

Leviticus 4:18. And he shall put some of the blood upon the horns of the altar which is before the LORD, that is in The Tabernacle of the Congregation, and shall pour out all the blood at the bottom of the altar of the Burnt Offering, which is at the door of The Tabernacle of the Congregation.

PUNISHMENT FOR;

Offering strange fire on.

Leviticus 10:1-2. And Nadab and Abihu, the sons of Aaron, took either of them his censer,

and put fire therein, and put incense thereon, and offered strange fire before the LORD, which he commanded them not. And there went out fire from the LORD, and devoured them, and they died before the LORD.

Unauthorized offering on.

2 Chronicles 26:16-19. But when he was strong, his heart was lifted up to his destruction: for he transgressed against the LORD his God, and went into the temple of the LORD to burn incense upon the Altar of Incense. And Azariah the priest went in after him, and with him fourscore priests of the LORD, that were valiant men: And they withstood Uzziah the king, and said unto him, It Appertaineth not unto thee, Uzziah, to burn incense unto the LORD, but to the priests the sons of Aaron, that are consecrated to burn incense: go out of the sanctuary; for thou hast trespassed; neither shall it be for thine honour from the LORD God. Then Uzziah was wroth, and had a censer in his hand to burn incense: and while he was wroth with the priests, the leprosy even rose up in his forehead before the priests in the house of the LORD, from beside the incense altar.

Covered by the priest before removal from the sanctuary.

Numbers 4:11. And upon the golden altar they shall spread a cloth of blue, and cover it with a covering of badgers' skins, and shall put to the staves thereof:

A type of Christ.

Revelation 8:3. And another angel came and stood at the altar, having a golden censer; and there was given unto him much incense, that he should offer it with the prayers of all Saints upon the golden altar which was before the throne.

Revelation 9:3. And there came out of the smoke locusts upon the earth: and unto them was given power, as the scorpions of the earth have power.